

Kickstart Assignment - Questions and Answers

Question 1: Install the kickstart package on your Linux server and verify the installation by running the appropriate command.

Answer:

Install Kickstart Tools:

```
sudo dnf install pykickstart -y
```

Verify Installation:

```
ksvalidator --version
```

Example Output:

pykickstart version information displayed successfully.

Question 2: Create a basic kickstart configuration file (ks.cfg) that automates the installation of CentOS or Rocky Linux with your preferred timezone, root password, and a user account named 'student'.

Answer:

Create File:

```
sudo nano ks.cfg
```

Example ks.cfg:

```
timezone Asia/Kolkata
```

```
rootpw RedHat123
```

```
user --name=student --password=Student123
```

```
reboot
```

Validate File:

```
ksvalidator ks.cfg
```

Question 3: Set up an HTTP server to serve your kickstart file and confirm access from another machine.

Answer:

Install Apache:

```
sudo dnf install httpd -y
```

Start Service:

```
sudo systemctl enable --now httpd
```

Copy ks.cfg:

```
sudo cp ks.cfg /var/www/html/
```

Verify Access:

```
curl http://SERVER_IP/ks.cfg
```

Or open in browser:

```
http://SERVER_IP/ks.cfg
```

Expected Result:

Kickstart file content is displayed successfully.

Question 4: Modify your kickstart file to automatically install GNOME and add a post-install script

that creates welcome.txt.

Answer:

Add the following to ks.cfg:

```
%packages
@^graphical-server-environment
%end
```

```
%post
echo "Welcome to your automated Linux setup!" > /home/student/welcome.txt
chown student:student /home/student/welcome.txt
%end
```

Validate Configuration:

```
ksvalidator ks.cfg
```

Expected Result:

GNOME desktop environment installs automatically and the file /home/student/welcome.txt is created with the required message after installation.